

Worried If Missing Persons (WIMP) Responsibilities

The following document details the roles, responsibilities, and procedures of the Outdoor Programs and Outing Club WIMP position. The term WIMP (Worry If Missing Persons) is used to denote the on-call person responsible for confirming the safe return of trips, or the reporting to proper authorities should a trip become overdue. When certain criteria concerning an overdue trip are met, protocols for contacting the trip and/or beginning emergency response communication are enacted. These criteria are listed in section 4.

1. WIMP Qualifications

- a. A WIMP is an elective position that changes from day-to-day
- b. WIMPs are REQUIRED for each day any trip is taking place
- c. A WIMP may be any one that meets the following criteria:
 - i. WIMPs must be in an area with cell service for the duration of their assigned time period
 - ii. *WIMPs must be provided with the Trip Plan for all trips going out during their responsible timeline

2. WIMP Training

- a. Any person wishing to volunteer for the on-call WIMP position must first complete the 1-hour WIMP Training clinic.
- b. The WIMP Training clinic is comprised of the following
 - i. A detailed overview of the WIMP role and responsibilities
 - ii. Understanding the differences between the Return By Time and the Emergency Action Time, and when to enact the protocols for each
 - iii. Understanding the Call Tree Order of Operations
 - iv. Scenario-based exercises

3. WIMP Procedures – Return By Time

- a. After the expired Return By Time
 - i. Call the trip leaders
 - ii. If no response, call the trip participants
 - iii. If no participants can be reached, call other members back on campus who may have knowledge of the trip's whereabouts
 - iv. If no person from the trip can be contacted or located by the above means, contact **James Bradbury – Associate Director, Outdoor Programs & Leadership
 - v. The WIMP and James will work together to organize a calling and response plan moving forward, should the WIMP Emergency Time expire

4. WIMP Procedures – Emergency Action Time

- a. When to enact after the WIMP Emergency Time expires
 - i. If the trip's status and whereabouts cannot be confirmed by the Emergency Time
 - ii. The trip leaders or participants have not notified the WIMP that all vehicles have returned to campus, OR

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- iii. The trip leader or a participant has not notified the WIMP that the WIMP time has been modified to a later time, or that return to campus will be delayed
- b. Procedure order for enacting an expired WIMP Emergency Action Time
 - i. If 911 is being called, confirm with the dispatcher as they may coordinate EMS response through their dispatching process. Discuss with the dispatcher the specific local emergency contacts you wish to contact (Park Office, State Police, local Search & Rescue, etc.)
 - ii. James Bradbury will call RPI Public Safety and the Dean of Students Office to inform them emergency protocols are being enacted, regardless of the level of emergency
 - iii. You may be instructed to make one of these calls on James' behalf
 - iv. James Bradbury and/or Public Safety will call Professional Emergency Services (as listed in the official trip sheet)

Included in Trip Plans*

1. The date of the trip
2. The location of the trip
3. The estimated DEPARTURE and RETURN times of the trip
4. The WIMP time (Cutoff time after which protocol is enacted)
5. A brief description of the location and activities being partaken
6. The trip leaders' and participants' names, RPI emails, and phone numbers
7. The make, model, color, and license plate number (including State) of each car associated with the trip
8. Directions to the beginning of the trip (such as a trailhead or put-in)
9. Directions to the end of the trip (such as a trail's end or a take-out)
10. The emergency action plan (proposed by the trip leaders), if an emergency were to happen on the trip
11. The evacuation routes (proposed by the trip leaders), if an emergency were to happen on the trip
12. Directions and contact information (phone number, address, hours of operation) for the nearest hospital and/or Urgent Care
13. Contact information for all relevant rescue and safety organizations in the region where the trip is taking place

*All above information is required for all ROC trips

**James Bradbury, Associate Director of Outdoor Programs & Leadership is the regular on-call professional for all Outdoor Programs and Rensselaer Outing Club trips. If James is unavailable as a resource for the time of a given trip, a secondary on-call professional will be appointed and will be reflected in the Trip Plan document.